Day 8 (stop 1 of 3) - Forty Mile Creek, Grimsby Point

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 10 · Beamer Memorial Conservation Area, Grimsby

6.5 km / 4.1 mi	~2.1 h	1.8 km new	57 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Grimsby Lions Community Pool: Enter at 1 Elm St at the south end of Coronation Park. Google Maps. **Free**

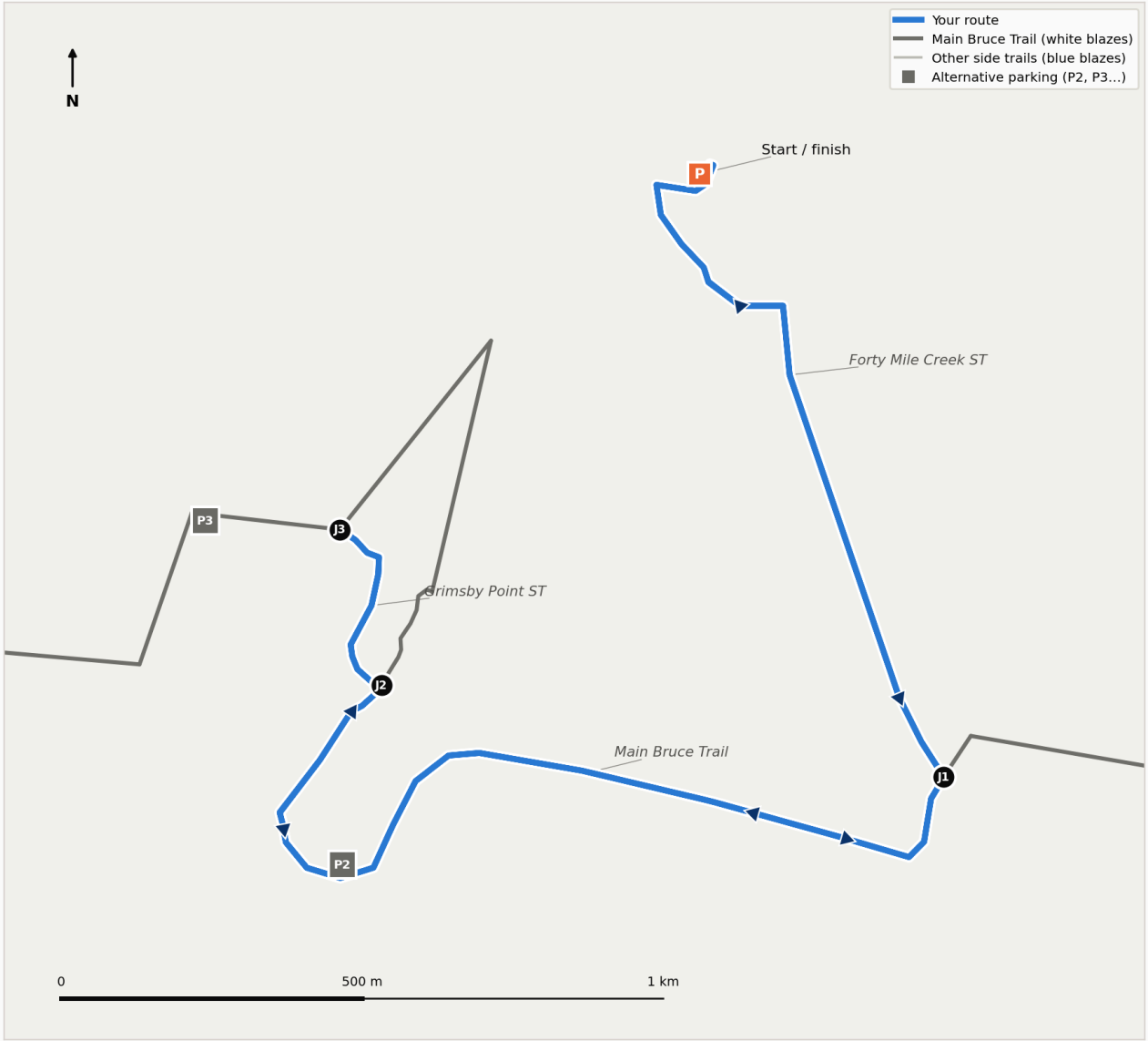
Navigate: import *day08a_hike010.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Forty Mile Creek Side Trail (1.5 km); Grimsby Point Side Trail (0.3 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 3 on day 8 (8.0 mi of hiking, about 162 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 11, 1.6 mi from Mountainview Conservation Area; stop 3: hike 12, 2.1 mi from Louth Conservation Area.

Route map

Day 8 (stop 1 of 3) | 6.5 km (4.1 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Start from the Grimsby Lions Community Pool lot, entering at 1 Elm St at the south end of Coronation Park.
- **Forty Mile Creek Side Trail:** In April 2026 this side trail was extended to 1.5 km over the former main Trail route, so it now runs up the wooded Forty Mile Creek valley to the corner of Mountain Street and Ridge Road East.
- **Road walking:** The BTC notice says the main Trail now follows Mountain Street to Ridge Road West, so expect road-shoulder walking on this stretch. Ridge Road is busy; keep Zappy close and stay off the roadway.

- **Beamers Falls:** The former Beamers Falls Side Trail is now main Trail from the Ridge Road West parking area, so look for white blazes rather than blue. Upper Beamer Falls is about 6 m high; the best view is from beside Ridge Road.
- **Grimsby Point Side Trail:** A short spur to escarpment-top lookouts at Beamer Memorial Conservation Area, a well-known spring hawk-watch site. The central observation deck closes from February 28 to May 15 for bird migration; the other lookouts stay open. Stay back from the cliff edges.
- **Staircase closure:** A damaged staircase in the conservation area was closed in April 2026 and the Trail was rerouted around it; a GVTA hike in July 2026 still described it as closed. A short leftover piece of the old route, reached from Gibson Street, is not part of the Bruce Trail. Follow the current blazes.
- **Cautions:** The scramble up the creek to Lower Beamer Falls is not an official trail and has loose, slippery rocks. Stay on the blazed route.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Parking Area: Off of Ridge Rd, located east of the southernmost portion of Beamers Falls Side... map	Free	2.8	190 m	Grimsby Point
P3	Beamer Memorial Conservation Area: Enter from Quarry Rd, which intersects with Ridge Rd W just... map	Free	3.4	260 m	Grimsby Point

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 2.8 km / 1.7 mi, covering Forty Mile Creek. **Outing 2** from P3 (Beamer Memorial Conservation Area: Enter from Quarry Rd, which intersects with Ridge Rd W just...; Free): 1.2 km / 0.7 mi, covering Grimsby Point. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Grimsby Lions Community Pool: Enter at 1 Elm St at the south end of Coronation Park. Head east on the blue-blazed Forty Mile Creek Side Trail.
0.1	0.0	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.2	0.8	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.3	0.8	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.9	1.8	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Grimsby Point Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
3.3	2.0	J3: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
3.6	2.2	J2: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
5.3	3.3	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Forty Mile Creek Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.) The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
6.0	3.7	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
6.5	4.1	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on a Bruce Trail Conservancy trail-change notice, the Grand Valley Trails Association and Ontario Hiking.